ESHERIA

LEGAL WORKFLOW OPERATING SYSTEM

From Fragmented Capabilities to a Legal Workflow OS.

The strategic case for platform-first legal AI.

Esheria moves from product-fragmented legal AI capabilities to a unified, auditable, governance-aware system with orchestration, shared canonical objects, governance controls, and institutional audit trails. This proposal argues the case, maps the architecture, defines the MVP, and names the four decisions needed to greenlight Phase 0.

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CLASSIFICATION

CONFIDENTIAL · CEO Review

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DOCUMENT DATE

2025

// EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The Platform Shift

Esheria currently operates five strong legal AI capabilities: document OCR and ingestion, contract compliance analysis, legal research and retrieval, AI-assisted drafting, and analytics infrastructure. Each operates as a credible, functioning service. However, they share no data model, no workflow state, and no orchestration layer—making them five separate products rather than one coherent platform.

This proposal argues that Esheria's most significant near-term strategic opportunity is not to add a sixth capability, but to build the orchestration layer above the five that already exist: a **Legal Workflow Operating System** with shared canonical objects, workflow state machines, human-in-loop review, approval chains, and institutional analytics.

> *// KEY INSIGHT*
>
> *Esheria's strongest long-term moat comes from becoming the programmable operating layer through which organisations run intelligent legal workflows—not from accumulating isolated AI features. Platform businesses compound. Feature businesses plateau.*

01 The Strategic Problem

// SECTION 01

Why five capabilities without a platform creates a growth ceiling

Current State Diagnosis

The current state across Esheria's ecosystem shows clear signs of capability fragmentation. Authentication and identity models differ across product surfaces. There is no shared canonical representation of Documents, Matters, or Clauses. Workflow state is not preserved between services. Analytics serves Esheria's internal operations but not customer organisations. There are no approval chains, escalation paths, or SLA enforcement mechanisms.

What Enterprise Buyers Actually Need

B2B enterprise buyers in legal, compliance, procurement, and financial services do not buy isolated AI features indefinitely. Their buying criteria are fundamentally different from individual user adoption:

Enterprise Requirement	Esheria Current Position
Repeatable, auditable workflows	Features without shared workflow state
Role-based access and controls	Varies by product surface
DMS, CRM, ERP integrations	Not yet systematised across services
Approval chains and escalation	Not present as platform primitives
Institution-facing analytics	Internal to Esheria operations only
Evidence-backed AI outputs	Output-only, not linked to citation source
Compliance and audit trails	Not a first-class architectural concern

// THE ENTERPRISE WORKFLOW IMPERATIVE

Upload a contract. Analyse it. Flag risks. Draft corrections. Route for review. Obtain approval. Close the matter. Generate a compliance report. That is one workflow. That is what enterprise legal teams will pay for at scale.

02 The Platform Thesis

// SECTION 02

Orchestration-first integration with governance, tenancy, and audit

From Features to Operating Layer

The core thesis is direct: Esheria should evolve from a collection of legal AI capabilities into a **programmable legal operations platform**—the operating layer through which organisations run intelligent legal workflows. This is a category shift, not merely a product expansion. The five existing repos become Layer 1 of a five-layer architecture. They are not rebuilt—they are connected.

Platform Capabilities

Component	Description
Canonical Object Model	Nine shared legal business objects—`Organization`, `Matter`, `Document`, `Clause`, `Risk`, `WorkflowRun`, `Action`, `Review`, `Citation`—that all services operate on.
Workflow Engine	State machine executing multi-step legal workflows with step routing, human review, approval chains, escalation logic, SLA enforcement, and full audit trails.
Connector Gateway	Single internal API gateway abstracting all five capability services. Frontends call `/api/*` only. Gateway routes to `/internal/*` services.
Multi-Tenant Core	Enterprise tenancy with isolated org data, users, roles, and workflow configs. Centralised Esheria operator console—never customer-accessible.
Institution Analytics	Customer-facing analytics layer, architecturally separate from Esheria internal analytics, giving legal teams operational intelligence over their own workflows.

The Platform Moat

#	Moat Source	How It Compounds
1	**Workflow Depth**	Embedded workflow logic creates switching cost that isolated features never produce.
2	**Ontology Quality**	When Esheria defines the canonical model for legal business objects, it becomes hard to replace.
3	**Institutional Memory**	Audit logs, approval histories, and clause decisions accumulate as irreplaceable org assets.
4	**Integration Surface**	DMS, CRM, ERP integrations embed Esheria in core business infrastructure.
5	**Platform Narrative**	A platform business is more expandable, more fundable, and harder to replace than a feature company.

03 Platform Architecture

// SECTION 03

Five-layer stack — existing services connected, not rebuilt

The platform is structured as five horizontal layers. Each has a distinct purpose and a bounded responsibility. No layer has a direct dependency on a non-adjacent layer. Existing capability repos plug into Layer 1 as-is.

Layer	Name	Purpose	Key Components
L5	**Experience**	Customer and operator frontend surfaces	Institution Workspace, Operator Console, Public Surface
L4	**Control Plane**	Orchestration, governance, audit	Workflow Engine, State Machine, Approval Router, Audit Log
L3	**Object Model**	Shared canonical legal business objects	Org, Matter, Document, Clause, Risk, WorkflowRun, Action, Citation
L2	**Connectors**	Stable gateway to all capability services	OCR, Contract, Research, Drafting, Analytics Connectors
L1	**Existing Services**	Current Esheria capability repos, unchanged	esheria-ocr, contract-engine, esheria-ai, lexdraft, esheria-analytics

// CRITICAL ARCHITECTURAL DECISION

Define and lock the Canonical Object Model (Layer 3) before writing any service code. The schema is the contract between all services, operators, and frontends. Treat schema changes within a major version with the same rigour as a public API breaking change.

04 The MVP: Contract Intake & Review

// SECTION 04

One workflow across all five services. One audit trail.

The recommended Phase 2 MVP is a Contract Intake and Review workflow. It is the narrowest, highest-value path to proving the platform thesis. It is commercially validated, technically achievable using existing capabilities, and architecturally complete—requiring orchestration across all five services in sequence.

End-to-End Workflow — 10 Steps

Step	Actor	Action	Output Object
01	**User**	Upload contract document	`Document + WorkflowRun`
02	**Ingestion Op**	OCR + validate + classify	`Parsed text, DocumentVersion`
03	**Extraction Op**	Extract clauses, parties, obligations	`Clause[] on Document`
04	**Compliance Op**	Check policies and regulations	`Risk[] with severity`
05	**Research Op**	Retrieve precedents + citations	`Citation[] linked`
06	**Drafting Op**	Generate fallback language	`Draft suggestions`
07	**Review Op**	Compile briefing + score risk	`Review record`
08	**Human Reviewer**	Decide + annotate	`Decision on Review`
09	**Routing Op**	Approve or escalate + enforce SLA	`Approval + SLA`
10	**Analytics Op**	Emit events + update dashboards	`Analytics updated`

05 Decision Metrics

// SECTION 05

Four measurements that define the before and after

Four metrics define the measurable difference between the current feature-level position and the platform target. Each maps a current state limitation to a specific, verifiable outcome.

Metric	Current State	Target State
Workflow Throughput	Per-service, measured per API call per capability	End-to-end per tenant — matters closed, SLA compliance rate
Compliance Assurance	Point-in-time checks, isolated, no audit chain	Workflow-level — risk linked to clause, citation, reviewer decision, timestamp
Platform Leverage	Feature-by-feature value, no compounding between services	OS-level retention — workflow depth creates switching cost
Enterprise Sales Motion	Individual user acquisition, demo-by-demo	Org subscription — sold to Head of Legal, CCO, procurement director

06 Phased Roadmap

// SECTION 06

18 to 27 weeks from greenlight to first B2B pilot

P0	P1	P2	P3	P4
Validation	>Design	>MVP Build	>Internal Pilot	>B2B Launch
2--3 wks	3--4 wks	6--8 wks	3--4 wks	4--6 wks

Phase	Name	Duration	Key Deliverables	Exit Milestone
P0	**Validation**	2–3 wks	CEO alignment, scope definition, service readiness audit, success criteria	**Greenlight + scope agreed**
P1	**Design**	3–4 wks	Canonical schema, workflow state machine, API contract spec, auth/tenant model	**Architecture doc approved**
P2	**MVP Build**	6–8 wks	Core backend, workflow engine, 2–3 connectors, reviewer dashboard v1, audit log	**Live end-to-end demo**
P3	**Pilot**	3–4 wks	Real scenario testing, refinement, operator console v1, performance baseline	**Validated platform**
P4	**B2B Launch**	4–6 wks	Target customer profile, onboarding, institution analytics v1, pricing model	**First pilot conversation**

07 The Ask

// SECTION 07

Four decisions — not a full platform rebuild

This proposal does not request a reorganisation, a new team, or a full platform rebuild. It requests four specific decisions that unlock the first proof-of-concept without disrupting anything that currently works.

1

Strategic Alignment

Confirm the platform direction—Esheria as a programmable legal workflow OS—is the right strategic bet for this phase of growth.

2

MVP Greenlight

Approve Phase 0 through Phase 2: validation, design, and MVP build culminating in a live Contract Intake and Review demo.

3

Platform Ownership

Name a platform lead to coordinate across existing repo owners. Without this, the orchestration layer will stall.

4

Pilot Target

Identify one B2B customer type or named prospect as the north star for MVP and B2B packaging phases.

// CLOSING STATEMENT

We are not asking to rebuild Esheria. We are asking for permission to prove that what Esheria has already built can operate as one coherent system—and that this coherence creates the enterprise story that drives the next phase of growth.

// SUPPORTING DOCUMENTATION

Full Reference Package

The following documents have been prepared alongside this proposal and are available for deep-review sessions with engineering, product, and design stakeholders.

Document	Contents	Audience
Technical Architecture Blueprint	Full engineering specification: 5-layer architecture, deployment topology, API contracts, data model, tenancy and auth model, implementation guidance	Engineering, CTO
Architecture Diagram Pack	8 engineering-grade SVG/PNG diagrams: system context, layered architecture, workflow sequence, data model, control/data plane, deployment, dashboard topology	All technical stakeholders
Product & Design Appendix	Screen-level design briefs for 5 surfaces: Institution Workspace, Operator Console, Workflow Monitor, Institution Analytics, Support & Incident Center	Product, design, engineering
Consistency Report	7 resolved inconsistencies across source artifacts; canonical architecture fact table confirming 11 agreed-correct design decisions	Engineering leads

A

Current Architecture

// SECTION A

System context — all actors, platform services, and external integrations

The system context diagram maps all actors interacting with the Esheria platform: institution users (legal reviewers, compliance officers, procurement leads), Esheria operators, API consumers, and external enterprise systems including DMS, CRM, and ERP. It establishes the trust boundaries and communication patterns the platform architecture must satisfy at the perimeter level.

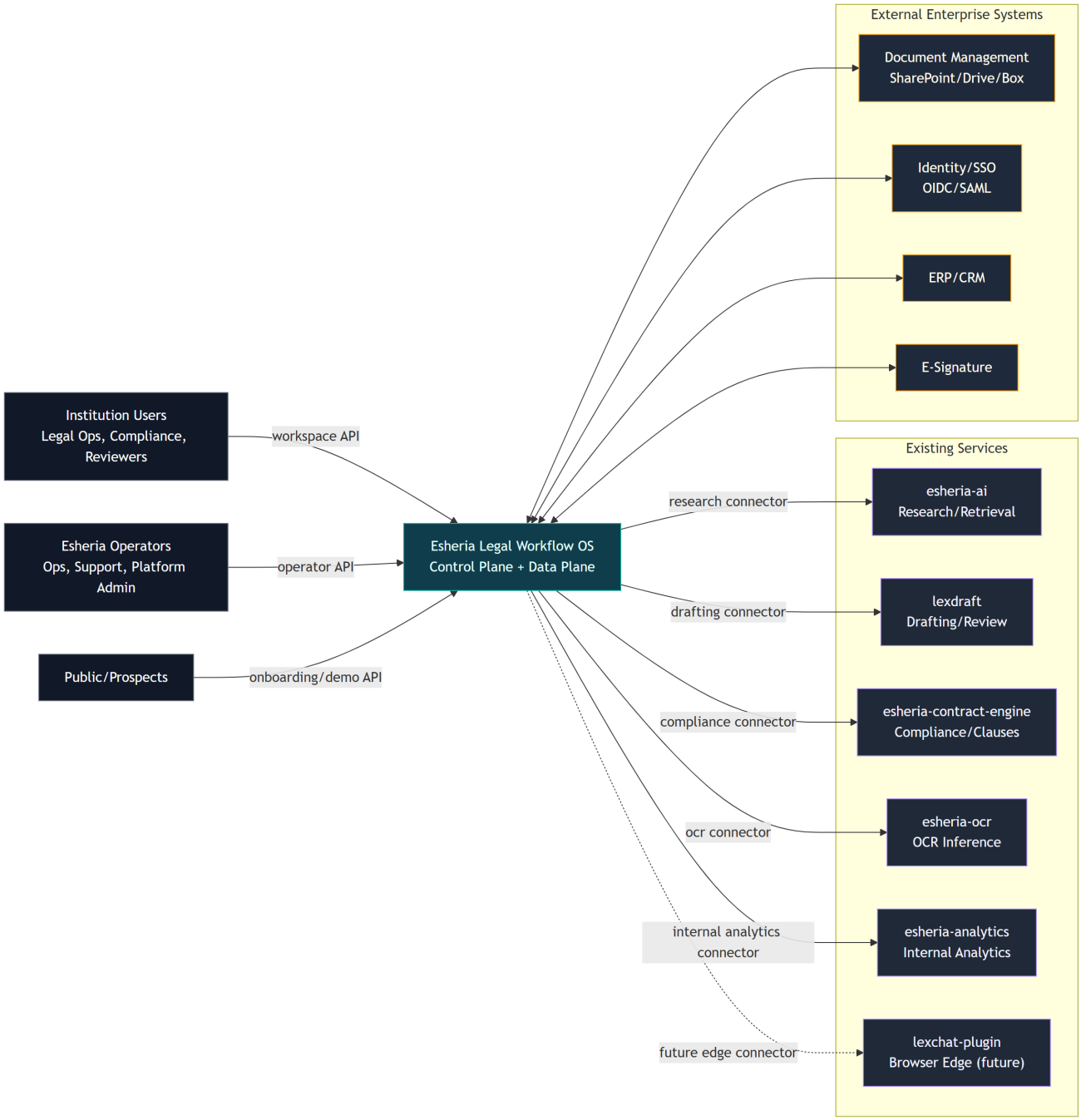

Figure 1: *

Figure A — Current system context across actors, platform services, and enterprise integrations

B Platform Architecture

// SECTION B

Target layered architecture with control and data plane separation

The layered architecture shows how the five platform layers stack above the current capability repos without requiring any service to be rebuilt. The control/data plane boundary between L3 and L4 is the primary governance mechanism. L5 surfaces only ever call `/api/*` endpoints. L2 connectors only ever call `/internal/*` endpoints. No layer has a direct dependency on a non-adjacent layer.

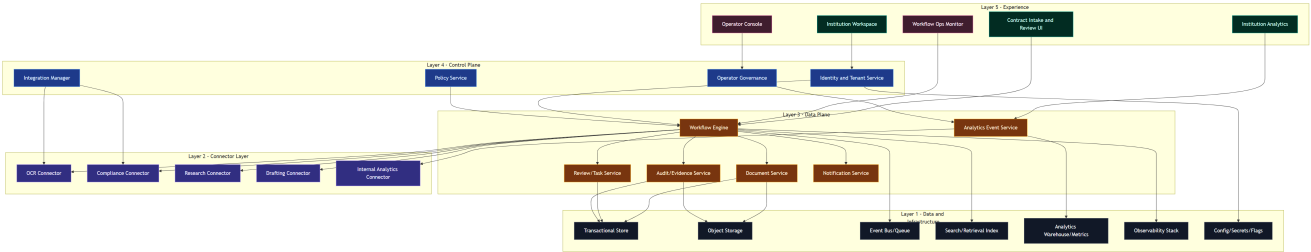

Figure 2: *

Figure B — Target five-layer architecture from existing services to experience surfaces

C Contract Intake Workflow

// SECTION C

End-to-end sequence for the Phase 2 MVP workflow

The contract intake sequence demonstrates the full orchestration thesis in one workflow. Eight AI operators and one human reviewer collaborate across all five capability services. Each step persists state to the canonical object model and produces an immutable audit log entry. The output is a human reviewer making an evidence-backed decision—the fundamental enterprise legal workflow primitive.

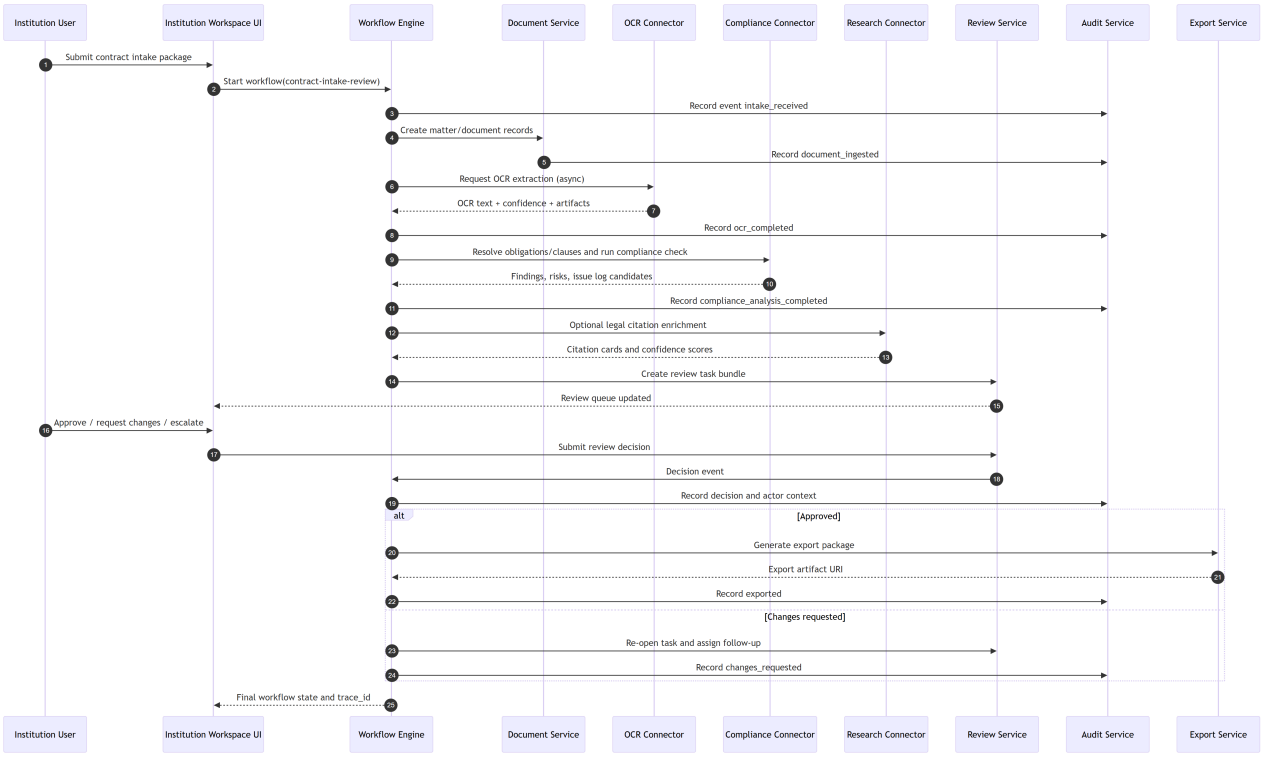

Figure 3: *

Figure C — Contract intake and review sequence across 8 operators and 1 human reviewer

D Dashboard Topology

// SECTION D

Customer vs operator surfaces and analytics domain separation

The dashboard topology establishes three completely separate frontend surfaces: the Institution Workspace (customer-facing B2B product), the Esheria Operator Console (internal control plane, never customer-accessible), and the Public/Sales Surface. The two analytics domains—Esheria internal operations and institution-facing analytics—must be architecturally separated from the outset.

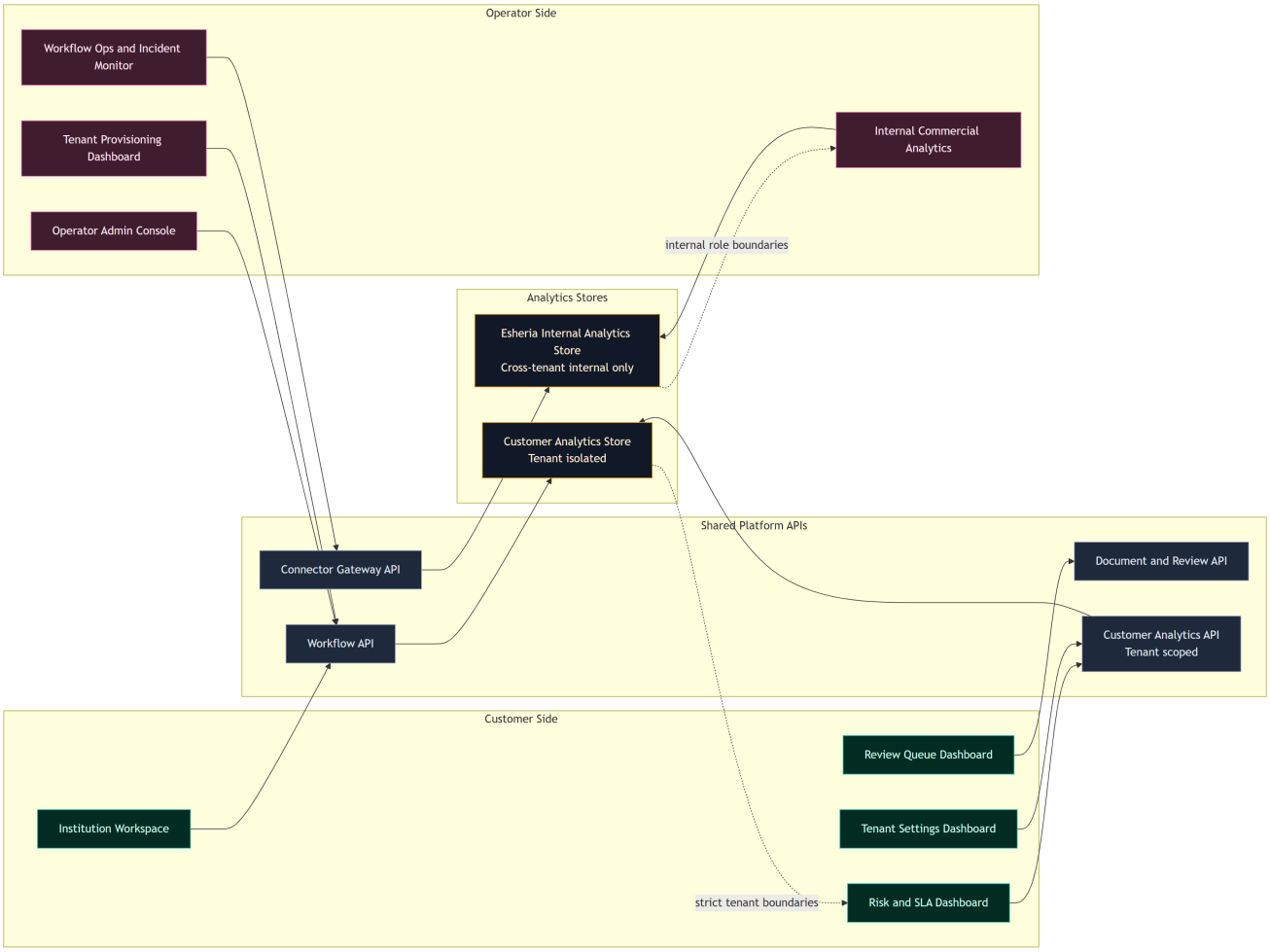

Figure 4: *

Figure D — Three distinct dashboard surfaces with separate auth flows and data scopes

E Service Integration Map

// SECTION E

Connector gateway routing across all five capability services

The service integration map shows how the Connector Gateway at Layer 2 abstracts all five existing capability services. No frontend or workflow operator ever calls a service directly. All platform-to-service calls route through the gateway's `/internal/*` namespace. Each connector owns the auth, retry, circuit-breaking, and error normalisation contract for its target service.

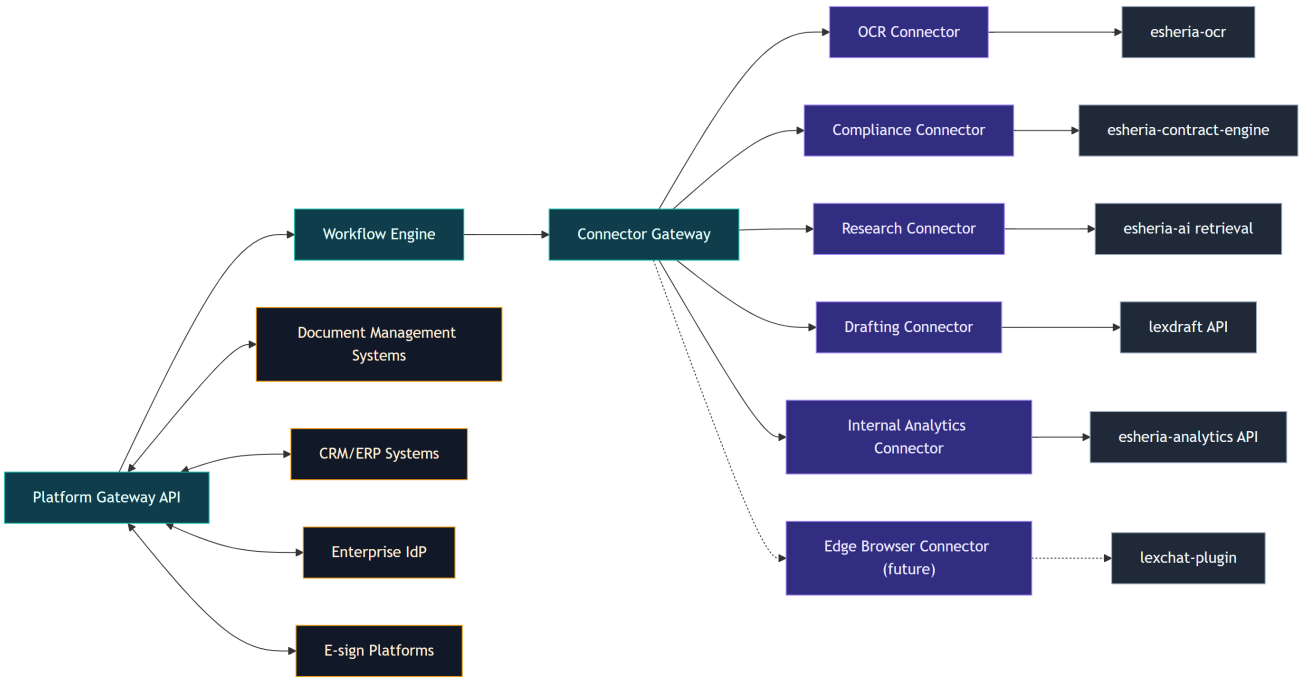

Figure 5: *

Figure E — Connector gateway integration map — all internal calls mediated by L2

F Deployment Topology

// SECTION F

Infrastructure stack, service boundaries, and data store configuration

The deployment topology shows the recommended MVP infrastructure: API gateway with TLS termination and rate limiting, stateless platform backend behind a load balancer, Redis Streams message queue for async step execution, PostgreSQL with row-level security for canonical object persistence, S3-compatible object storage for documents, and a vector store for research and retrieval.

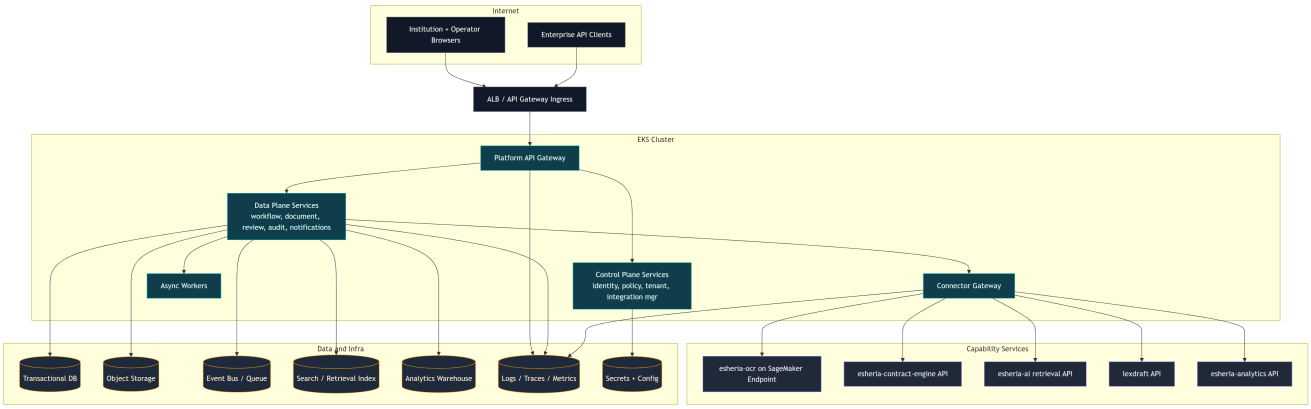

Figure 6: *

Figure F — Deployment topology across API gateway, backend services, queues, and data stores

G Transformation Roadmap

// SECTION G

Architecture evolution from current state to target platform

The transformation diagram maps the journey from current state (five isolated repos with independent auth and no shared model) to target state (unified platform with canonical objects, shared workflow state, and institutional analytics). The key design decision is preserved throughout: existing repos remain operational and are connected into the platform as Layer 1, not replaced.

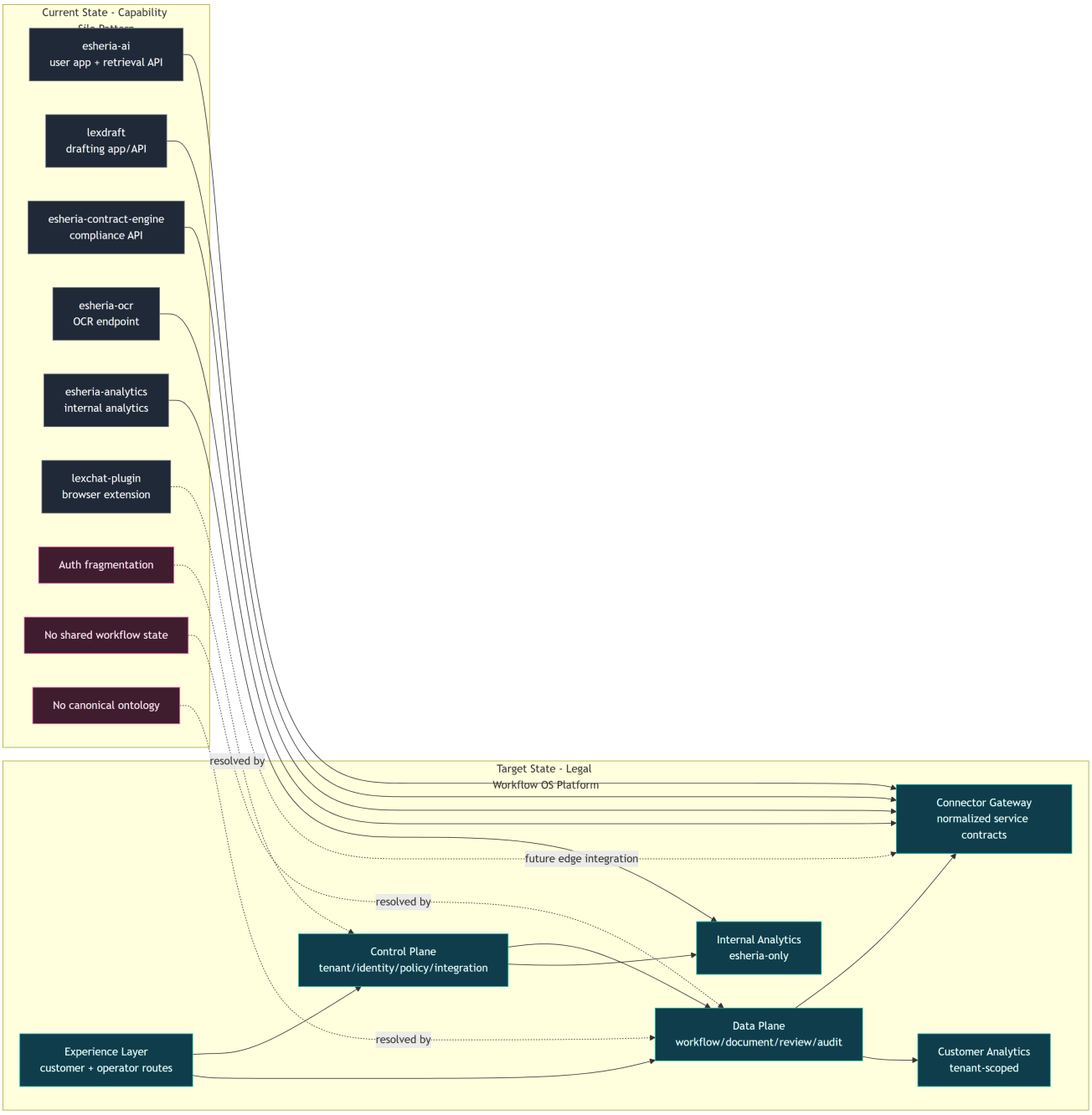

Figure 7: *

Figure G — Transformation from five isolated capabilities to one coherent platform